Zirou Chen

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Academic Position

2026-Now Assistant Professor in Marketing, School of Business, Hong Kong Baptist University

Education

2020-2026 Ph.D. in Management (Quantitative Marketing), University of Toronto
– Committee: Nitin Mehta (Advisor), Matthew Osborne, Mengze Shi, Zemin Zhong

2015-2018 M.A. in Economics, University of Rochester

2011-2015 B.A. in Economics & B.S. in Mathematics, Wuhan University

Research Interests

Substantive: Media Consumption, Platform Strategy, Consumer search, Personalization

Methodological: Structural Modeling, Causal Inference, Game Theory

Working Papers

1. Predictive Accuracy, Consumer Search, and Personalized Recommendation, with Mengze Shi and Zemin Zhong
2. Gamification in Digital Consumption: Evidence from TikTok, with Nitin Mehta and Matthew Osborne
3. Preference for Diversity, with Ying Zeng, Jiajia Liu, and Jingyi Lu
4. Product Relevance, Consumer Search, and Competition, with Bing Jing and Mengze Shi

Publications

1. AI-assisted Teams Outperform AI-led Teams But Not Human-only Teams in Assessing Research Reproducibility in Quantitative Social Science, Social Science Crowd Analysis led by Brodeur et al., ***Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences,*** June 2026, Vol. 123, No. 22

Conference Presentation

1. 2026/06 INFORMS Marketing Science Conference, Nova School of Business and Economics
2. 2025/06 Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy, University of California, Berkeley*
3. 2025/06 INFORMS Marketing Science Conference, Washington D.C.*
4. 2024/03 TD MDAL Grant Research Roundtable
5. 2023/12 Conference on AI, ML, and Business Analytics, Temple University
6. 2023/06 INFORMS Marketing Science Conference, University of Miami
7. 2023/05 Empirical & Theoretical Symposium for Canadian Marketing Strategy, Queen's University

8. 2021/06 INFORMS Marketing Science Conference, University of Rochester^{v}
9. 2019/07 International Conference on Game Theory, Stony Brook University

* indicates "attending but a coauthor presented the paper" | ^{v} indicates "virtual"

Grants and Awards

1. 2025 ISMS Doctoral Consortium Fellow, Washington DC
2. 2024 Management Analytics Research Cluster Fund, University of Toronto
3. 2023 TD MDAL Research Grant, University of Toronto
4. 2023 ISMS Doctoral Consortium Fellow, Miami
5. 2022-2023 BEAR/BI-Org Ph.D. Research Grant, University of Toronto
6. 2021-2022 BEAR/BI-Org Ph.D. Research Grant, University of Toronto
7. 2020-2025 Rotman School of Management Fellowship, University of Toronto
8. 2018-2020 Wallis Institute Fellowship, University of Rochester
9. 2015-2018 Graduate Fellowship, University of Rochester
10. 2011-2015 First Prize Undergraduate Scholarship, Wuhan University

Teaching

Marketing Management (undergraduate), Fall 2026

Miscellaneous

Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent)

Computer Skills: Julia, R, Python, Stata, MATLAB, LaTeX